Ali Ahmadi

Queen's University, Smith School of Business
Ali.Ahmadi@queensu.ca - AliAhmadi.site – LiveCases.org

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Competitive Dynamics, Behavioral Strategy, Artificial Intelligence, Innovation, and Entrepreneurship

EDUCATION

PhD Candidate in Management, Strategy **2021- 2027**
Queen's University, Smith School of Business, Kingston, Ontario
Dissertation Title: *Competitive Surprise: A research agenda*
Committee*: Professors Goçe Andrevski, Danny Miller, Anthony Goerzen, Jean-Baptiste Litrico*
Proposal defended December 2025

MBA in Strategy **2020**
Industrial Management Institute, Tehran, Iran;

BSc in Mechanical Engineering **2017**
Babol Noshirvani Institute of Technology, Babol, Iran;

PUBLICATIONS

Goudarzi, K., **Ahmadi, A**., & Andrevski, G. (2026). From protection to adjustment: How rival repositioning alters competitive action repertoires. *Journal of Business Research* (Link) *(ABDC: A-Journal)*

REVISE AND RESUBMIT

Andrevski, G., **Ahmadi, A.**, & Miller, D. Competitive Surprise: A Theoretical Framework. Invited for 3rd round revise and resubmit at the *Academy of Management Review (FT50 – ABDC: A*)*

ADVANCED WORKS IN PROGRESS

Ahmadi, A., Andrevski, G., Miller, D., Antecedents and Performance Implications of Surprise Capability: An Empirical Analysis. Submitting to *Academy of Management Journal* in Fall 2026 *(Final Edits). (Smith Insight media coverage of our method)*

Ahmadi, A., Andrevski, G., Miller, D., Competitive Surprise and Rival Response Time: An Event Study. Target Journal: *Academy of Management Journal*. *(Data analysis)*

Ahmadi, A., Goudarzi, K., How Merger Announcements Shape Investor and Rival Responses: Insights from an AI text analysis. Target Journal: *Academy of Management Journal*. *(Data analysis).*

Pimentel, E., **Ahmadi, A.,** Bel Hadj Ali, S., Ricci, L. Bodies at Work: A Critical Review and Organizing Framework for a Corporeal Approach to Organization Studies. *(Final Edits).* Submitting to *Journal of Management Studies in 2026*

OTHER PROJECTS

Competitive Themes: Shared Rationales Among Interrelated Competitive Actions with Goçe Andrevski (Data Analysis) – (Pilot study visualization)

Competitive Surprise: A Multiple Case-Study with Goçe Andrevski *(Ethics accepted, participant recruitment stage)*

Anticipated departures and team investment: a longitudinal archival study in Formula 1 racing with Kaylee Somerville *(Data collected, analysis stage)*

BOOK CHAPTERS

Ahmadi, A., & Arndt, F. (2022). Dynamic Capabilities and Innovation. in Innovation; Routledge.

Salamzadeh, A., **Ahmadi, A.,** & Safar Kamel, A. (2022). The Context for Business in Iraq. Understanding Contexts of Business in *Western Asia: Land of Bazaars and High-Tech Booms*

Toghraee, M. T., **Ahmadi, A.,** & Salamzadeh, A. (2022). Arts entrepreneurs in an emerging economy. *In Artisan and handicraft entrepreneurs: past, present, and future* (pp. 137-147). Springer International Publishing.

Hosseini, E., Tajpour, M., Salamzadeh, A., & **Ahmadi, A.** (2022). Team performance and the development of Iranian digital start-ups: the mediating role of employee voice. In *Managing human resources in SMEs and start-ups: international challenges and solutions*

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor, Queen's University **Fall 2024, 2025**
Business and Corporate Strategy - COMM 401
1 Section – Fall 2024 - 85 Students - Evaluation: 6.23/7
1 Section – Fall 2025 – 84 Students - Evaluation: 6.71/7
Developed a novel AI-powered case delivery method on https://LiveCases.org

Workshop Instructor, Queen's University
Teaching with AI – Interactive AI-powered Case Studies
- Teaching & Learning in Business PhD course **2025**
- Strategy faculty brownbag **2024**

Python Programming with AI for non-tech commerce students **2025**
Data access from web and APIs – University of St. Andrews, Scotland (link) **2026**
Text Processing with Language Models – University of St. Andrews, Scotland **2026**
(Link to Github repository)

Teaching Assistant, Queen's University **2022 - 2025**

Undergraduate

Business and Corporate Strategy – Capstone (2022, 2023, 2025, 2026)
(view my interactive TA platform)
Business for Good (2023, 2024)

MBA and EMBA

Business and Corporate Strategy - MBA (2022,2023,2024,2025,2026)
Dynamic Strategy Execution – MBA (2023, 2026)
Strategic Thinking and Execution - MBA (2024, 2025, 2026)
Role of the General Manager - EMBA with Cornell University (2025, 2026)

AWARDS

Best Paper Award **July 2026**
Competitive Dynamics Conference
University of Virginia, Darden School of Business

Program on Investment Appraisal and Risk Analysis Scholarship (USD 15,900) **June 2026**
Queen's University Economics Department

PhD Student Research Excellence Award ($1,500) **April 2025**
Smith School of Business

D.D. Monieson Doctoral Fellowship ($5,000) **Feb 2025**
Smith School of Business

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Community Builder and Business Analyst **Aug 2019 - Mar 2021**
Hamboodgah Crowdfunding, Tehran, Iran

Business Analyst **May 2018 - Jan 2019**
Rata Crowdfunding, Tehran, Iran

Business Analyst Intern **Jan 2018 - May 2018**
ILIA International Consulting, Tehran, Iran

NON-PROFIT AND VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

Judge **2023-2025**
ICBC, Kingston, Ontario

Founder and Managing Director **Dec 2012 - Nov 2017**
Sari Astronomy Club
Non-Profit NGO for public science communication

Licensee and Organizer **Mar 2016 - Mar 2018**
TEDx Sari
the third city-scale TEDx event in Iran

Speechwriter and Curator **Apr 2018 – Feb 2021**
TEDx Amirkabir University (May 2019)
TEDx Esfahan (Dec 2020, Aug 2019)
TEDx HSU (Apr 2018)
TEDx University of Tehran (Jul 2022, Feb 2021)

Languages

English **Bilingual – C2**
IELTS General 8.5/9 – IELTS Academic 8/9

Persian **Native**

French **Professional –B2**

Turkish **Professional – B1**

Azeri **Professional – B1**

Arabic **Limited Proficiency – A2**